



Reading Group: Against Military AI

Session 4: Deepfakes in Warfare

Purpose of this reading group

- Open and respectful discussion about the use of AI for military purposes
- Topic is challenging
- Open to critiques of governments, companies and other institutions
- Objective: learn and discuss together
- We trust you to commit towards making this discussion respectful, inclusive and accountable

Accountability

Accountability means being responsible for yourself, your intentions, words and actions. It means entering a space with good intentions, but understanding that aligning your intent with action is the true test of commitment

Invitations

- Honour yourself: breaks, water
- Honour each other: listen & share generously. Empathy
- Practise sharing the mic
- Learning mindset. Curiosity

House rules

- Personal attacks and any kind of discrimination (anti-semitism, islamophobia, etc.) will not be tolerated
- Remote participants are required to have their cameras on
- No video / audio recordings are allowed

Voice Cloning - Sudan Genocide

Reading: [AI: Voice cloning tech emerges in Sudan civil war](#)

1 year of the genocide in Sudan:

+15000 death.

+33000 injured person.

+6.5 Million displaced.

+2 Million refugee.

Multiple massacres (Ardamata massacre, Misterei massacre and the Geneina massacre ...).

No access to internet.

Main actors: Wagner Group (Russian militia), United Arab Emirates (UAE), IDF.

Voice Cloning - Sudan Genocide

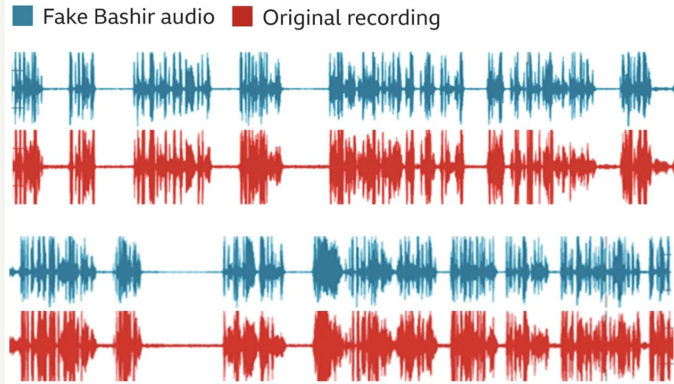
Reading: [AI: Voice cloning tech emerges in Sudan civil war](#)

Fake voice recordings of the previous leader of Sudan:

- Create fake content easily.
- A wave of disinformation and confusion.
- Real danger: Disbelieve even real recordings.

Evidence: Omar al-Bashir's voice was cloned

The audio waves show the two recordings appear to match



Source: Prof Hany Farid, University of California, Berkeley



Image Generation - Gaza Genocide

Reading: Fake babies, real horror: Deepfakes from the Gaza war increase fears about AI's power to mislead

Fake images of atrocities:

- Claims circulating online about the war didn't require AI to create: fake images discredit the actual ones.
- Gain immense support.
- Emotional impact, engagement of the first exposure.

'BEHEADED BABIES' - HOW UK MEDIA REPORTED ISRAEL'S FAKE NEWS AS FACT

Video Generation - Ukraine-Russia War

Reading:

Fake babies, real horror: Deepfakes from the Gaza war increase fears about AI's power to mislead.
Deepfakes in warfare: new concerns emerge from their use around the Russian invasion of Ukraine

Fake video of the ukrainian president announcing surrender:

- Claims circulating for a long time even after being debunked:
 - => how persistent even easily debunked misinformation can be.
 - => What are the implications on elections? Framing political opponents? ...

Deepfakes implications - What does the data say?

Reading:

[Do deepfake videos undermine our epistemic trust? A thematic analysis of tweets that discuss deepfakes in the Russian invasion of Ukraine](#)

[Deepfakes in warfare: new concerns emerge from their use around the Russian invasion of Ukraine](#)

How people reacted to the fake video of the ukrainian president announcing surrender:

- Confusion and scepticism
- Loss of trust

Deepfakes implications - What does the data say?

Confusion and scepticism:

- Tweets examples:
 - “We can’t always trust our eyes anymore. Not that this video is fake, but all possibilities need to be considered” - Tweet on another video of the war
 - “None of the videos coming out of this war can be trusted.”
- Videos made by Ukraine for educational purposes created suspicion towards real ones.
- Numerous examples of videos that people falsely claimed were deepfakes.

Loss of trust:

- People lost faith in all footages coming from the war.
- Emergence of conspiracy theories: “Putin is dead and they are using deepfakes to replace him”

Are fact-checking methods enough?

Psychological warfare. The damage is already done.